



## SECTION A

### Reading Skills

**20 marks**

1. Read the following passage carefully :

10

- (1) With the growing focus on sustainable living, the importance of kitchen gardens in urban regions has garnered greater acknowledgement. One significance of kitchen gardens in urban areas is their role in promoting food security. Rapid urbanization has led to increased distances between food production centres and urban settlements, resulting in longer food supply chains and a decrease in the freshness and nutritional value of food.
- (2) By having a kitchen garden, urban dwellers can grow their own fresh produce at home, making good use of empty tins, old utensils, and clay flower pots, ensuring a constant supply of nutritious food for themselves and their families. This activity not only saves money and time but can also provide a healthy, practical, and environmentally friendly hobby for the whole family.
- (3) Not only do kitchen gardens contribute to food security, but they also play a crucial role in environmental sustainability. Traditional agricultural practices often involve the use of synthetic fertilizers, pesticides, and intensive irrigation methods, which may have adverse effects on the environment. However, kitchen gardens promote organic farming, reducing the use of harmful chemicals and preserving soil health.



- (4) In addition to fostering a sustainable environment, kitchen gardens provide numerous health benefits to urban dwellers. The availability of fresh and organic produce from the garden ensures a higher intake of essential nutrients, vitamins, and minerals, promoting better overall health and well-being.
- (5) Furthermore, kitchen gardens have proven to be an effective tool for education and community development. They provide an opportunity for individuals to reconnect with nature and learn about the basics of agriculture. Besides providing fruits and vegetables, gardening provides an aesthetic and therapeutic exercise that helps relieve stress. The physical activity involved in tending to a garden helps individuals stay active, reducing the risk of obesity and related health issues.
- (6) By involving children in gardening activities, they can develop an appreciation for the environment and learn essential life skills. Moreover, kitchen gardens can also serve as a platform for community engagement, fostering social interactions and promoting a sense of belonging among urban residents.
- (7) Despite the numerous benefits of kitchen gardens, establishing and maintaining one in urban areas can be challenging. Limited space, lack of sunlight, and soil quality issues are common obstacles that urban gardeners face. However, innovative solutions such as vertical gardening, hydroponics, and rooftop gardens have emerged to overcome these challenges.



- (8) It is imperative to provide support and resources to encourage urban gardening initiatives as this can transform urban areas into sustainable havens where residents not only live but thrive in harmony with nature.

Answer the following questions, based on the above passage :

- (i) What does the writer's use of phrases like 'in urban regions kitchen gardens have garnered great acknowledgement' suggest about kitchen gardening today ? 1

- (A) It has reduced inflation.
- (B) It is an expensive hobby.
- (C) It provides nutritious food.
- (D) It does not minimize adverse effects on the environment.

Paragraph (1)

- (ii) Complete the following with a suitable explanation. 1

Growing a kitchen garden is cost effective because \_\_\_\_\_.

Paragraph (2)

- (iii) Identify two differences between the methods adopted in traditional farming and kitchen gardens. Paragraph (3) 2



- (iv) Substitute the underlined word with the correct word from Paragraph (4). 1

The local residents' nurturing of their surrounding flora and fauna helps to create awareness about civic responsibilities.

- (v) Tending to a kitchen garden has many health benefits. Explain in about 40 words. Paragraphs (4) and (5) 2

- (vi) Select the option that best reflects the concept that kitchen gardening is an effective educational tool for children. 1

(A) It contributes to effective community development.

(B) It helps develop sensitivity and appreciation for nature.

Paragraph (5)

- (vii) What hurdles do kitchen gardeners face ? Mention any two. 1

Paragraph (7)

- (viii) State whether the following statement is *True* or *False* : 1

Kitchen gardening should be practised by everyone living in the cities.